

Fast Track tip: If you're on a train/flight and don't want to use the keyboard, four-finger swipe becomes your silent superpower.

5) Give each desktop a different wallpaper

This is not cosmetic. It's *cognitive*. If "Work" is a calm solid gradient and "Personal" is your wallpaper chaos, you'll instantly know where you are even mid-meeting.

Microsoft's official steps:

1. Open Task View (Win + Tab)
2. Right-click the desktop you want
3. Select Choose background

One limitation Microsoft explicitly calls out: per-desktop unique backgrounds work when using a Picture. You can't use a different slideshow or solid color for each desktop.

Practical wallpaper scheme (steal this)

- **Work:** clean, minimal, low-contrast
- **Meetings:** something obvious (bright color / bold pattern) so you never share the wrong thing
- **Study:** calming / neutral
- **Personal:** whatever chaos makes you happy

6) Move apps between desktops

Method A: Drag-and-drop in Task View

1. Open Task View (Win + Tab).
2. You'll see your open windows.
3. Drag a window to the desktop thumbnail you want.
4. Drop it.

Microsoft explicitly describes this drag-and-drop between desktops as part of Task View.

Method B: Right-click "Move to" (quick control)

Some builds also let you:

- Right-click an app/window and choose Move to → select a desktop (or "New desktop"). This behavior is commonly documented in Microsoft's Q&A guidance for Windows 11 virtual desktops.

Fast Track habit: At the end of each day, do a 30-second cleanup:

- Work windows stay on Work desktop.
- Personal stays on Personal.
- Meetings desktop stays empty until needed.

That one ritual prevents tomorrow's chaos.

7) Pin "always-needed" windows across desktops

Sometimes you want one app everywhere:

- Music app
- Chat app

- Notes app
- Timer
- Calculator

Windows offers options like "show on all desktops" in the desktop context menus (commonly accessed through Task View). If you want to keep things clean, use this sparingly – pinning everything everywhere defeats the purpose.

Rule: only pin what you truly need in every context.



8) Control what appears in Alt+Tab and the taskbar

Here's the part most people miss: you can decide whether your taskbar and Alt+Tab show only windows from your current desktop or everything from all desktops.

Microsoft documents these exact settings under Settings → System → Multitasking → Desktops.

Step-by-step: Choose taskbar behavior across desktops

1. Open Settings
2. Go to System → Multitasking
3. Expand Desktops
4. Under On the taskbar, show all the open windows, choose:
 - Only on the desktop I'm using (cleaner, focused)
 - On all desktops (faster jumping, but cluttered)

Step-by-step: Choose Alt+Tab behavior across desktops

In the same Desktops section:

- Under Show all open windows when I press Alt+Tab, choose whether Alt+Tab shows windows from:
 - all desktops, or
 - only the current one

My recommendation for most people:

- Taskbar: Only on the desktop I'm using (keeps the taskbar sane)
- Alt+Tab: depends on how chaotic your life is
 - If you're disciplined: current desktop only
 - If you're in "everything is urgent" mode: all desktops